

Summer of Claude

Faculty workshop · Learning Lab Studio, 50 Church St. · 1:00–2:30pm · four afternoons

You don't need to code. Beyond the **desktop app**, you don't need anything complicated installed for today. The goal of these four days is **a good plan for your own work** — the deliverable is your thinking, not a finished product. We'll work to get everyone up to speed at their own pace, and anything you miss during the workshop we'll send you afterward as an async handout. Stay in whichever interface feels comfortable; we'll always show you where the ceiling is and how to step past it when you're ready.

TODAY (DAY 1) — GETTING STARTED: WHERE CLAUDE LIVES, AND A FRAME

By the end of today you'll know *where* you can work with Claude and what each place is for, you'll have a working setup in **Cowork**, and you'll have a mental model we use all week.

- **One model, many front doors.** There's a single LLM underneath; everything else is a different way of reaching it. The closer you get, the more the choices are *yours* rather than defaulted for you. We'll compare:
 - **The web** (claude.ai in a browser) — ask a question, get an answer.
 - **The desktop app** — the same Chat, plus **Cowork** (hand Claude your files and work together) and a view into **Claude Code**.
 - **Claude Code in the command line and your editor (IDE)** — build workflows that run on your files repeatedly, at scale.
- **A little AI literacy** — why it's a predictor and not a calculator, how it reads text, where its memory lives, picking a model.
- **A frame for everything: inputs → operations → outputs.** A simple way to map any task — we reuse this frame all week.
- **The context window as a recipe.** What you put in front of Claude — your files, instructions, examples — is like the ingredients and steps on a **recipe card**. (We'll work with actual recipe-card images as our sample data.) Get the recipe right and the dish comes out right; leave something out and it won't.
- **Why Cowork** — where the web interface runs out of room, and what working *with* your files looks like (we'll demo, not make you keep pace).
- **All of it, live, side by side** — web, desktop app, and a first look at Claude Code — the bridge into tomorrow.

Take-home reference: the interface decision grid (when to use the web vs. Cowork vs. Claude Code) and a markdown cheatsheet.

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

Each day builds on the last. The arc moves from *understanding the tool* to *working in it* to *making things with it*.

DAY	THEME	WHAT YOU'LL DO
1 — today	The many Claudes & AI basics	Compare web / desktop app / Claude Code; set up Cowork; learn inputs → operations → outputs and the context-as-recipe metaphor
2	Claude Code as an authoring environment — not just for programmers	Open Claude Code ; clone the workshop repo; meet its commands, tools, and conventions — CLAUDE.md , memory, skills
3	Advanced tools & scaling your work	Go deeper on the advanced toolkit — especially skills, agents and subagents — and the ways you can scale a workflow up to many files and repeated runs
4	Creating outputs	Put it together to produce real outputs in your own material — for teaching, research, or both — the thing you leave with. Gallery of examples as a menu

A FEW THINGS TO KNOW

- **Cowork-only is a real path.** You can do all four days in Cowork and never touch a command line. Staying there won't leave you behind.
- **Days 2, 3 and 4 work in the desktop app too.** On Day 2 we'll demo the command-line install and tooling; after that, everything we show we'll show in **both** the desktop app and the CLI. Maybe ~10% of what we do is easier in the CLI, but nearly everything can be accomplished in either.

Questions during the week? Ask anyone on the Learning Lab team.